Galveston County District Court

Cause No. 2024-CV-0042

Samantha Steele, Plaintiff, v. Harbor Point Mutual Auto Insurance, Defendant

Oral Deposition of Samantha Steele

Date:	November 21, 2024
Location:	Offices of Morris & Miller LLP
Examining attorney:	Marilyn Fox, Ashford & Lyle LLP
Defending attorney:	Joshua Whitney, Morris & Miller LLP

Q: Please state your full name for the record.

A: I'd rather not give my full name on the record. I'm the plaintiff, and I can be identified as the plaintiff.

Q: Understood. Let's begin with the accident. Where were you when it happened?

A: I was driving through an intersection in League City, Texas, haeding east on the main road. It was a clear afternoon, and I had a green light.

Q: What happened as you entered the intersection?

A: A vehicle coming from the cross street ran through its red light and struck the driver's side of my car. It hit me right behind the front door. My car spun a little and ended up against the curb on the far side.

Q: Did you see the other vehicle before the impact?

A: Only for a second. I saw it moving fast toward the intersection, but I didn't have time to brake or swerve. I just braced myself on the steering wheel.

Q: Were you able to get out of the vehicle on your own?

A: Yes, but my left arm hurt badly and I was shaking. A bystander helped me step out and sat with me until the ambulance arrived.

Q: Where did you first receive medical care?

A: I was taken by ambulance to a local emergency room. They took X-rays and told me my left wrist was fractured.

Q: What treatment have you received since then?

A: They set the wrist and put me in a cast. A few weeks later I had a follow-up visit, and the orthopedic doctor said I would need physical therapy to regain my grip strength and range of motion. I've been attending therapy twice a week since then.

Q: How has the injury affected your daily life?

A: It's been hard. I'm right-handed, but I still rely on my left hand for many things, like opening jars, buttoning shirts, and carrying groceries. I had to ask my family to help with cooking and cleaning for a while. I also stopped going to my weekly tennis group because I can't grip a racket yet.

Q: Have you been able to return to work?

A: I was out for several weeks. Now I work part-time with modified duties, because typing for long periods still causes pain in my wrist.

Q: Do you still experience symptoms today?

A: Yes. The wrist aches when the weather changes, and it gets stiff if I sit still for too long. My therapist says I'm making progress, but I don't feel like I'm back to normal yet.